PRANA 🫁 · SETUP GUIDE

# PRANA on Discord

Your autonomous AI brain as a Discord bot. Tag it in any channel — it thinks with real tools and answers in-thread.

| ~5 min | 2 min | Windows |
| --- | --- | --- |
| total setup | your human steps | first-class |

🤖 AUTOMATIC — PRANA / installer does it  👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP — needs a human (account / browser)

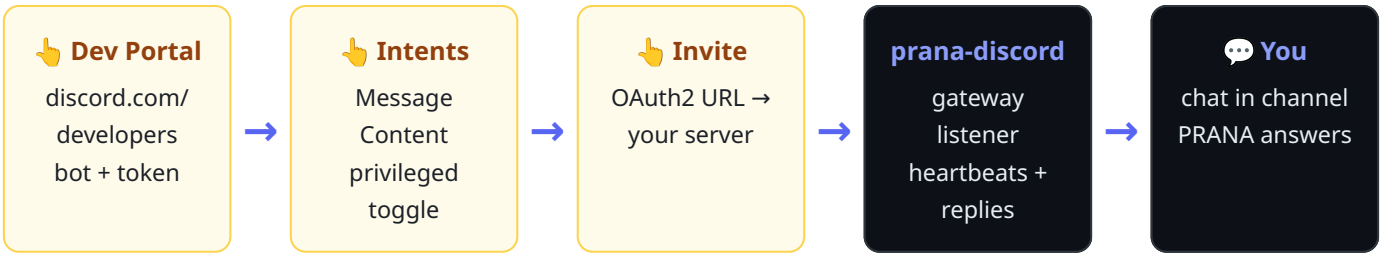
### 📑 Contents

1. What you're building
2. How the pieces fit (flow diagram)
3. Step 1 — Install PRANA
4. Step 2 — Save your AI key
5. Step 3 — Create the Discord application 👆 YOUR STEP
6. Step 4 — Copy the bot token 👆 YOUR STEP
7. Step 5 — Enable the Message Content intent ⚠️ 👆 YOUR STEP
8. Step 6 — Invite the bot to your server 👆 YOUR STEP
9. Step 7 — Give PRANA the token & start it
10. Verify it works ✅
11. Troubleshooting
12. Quick reference

## What you're building

After this guide, **PRANA is a bot on your Discord server**: message it in any channel, it runs its full brain (ReAct loop, shell/files/web tools, memory, per-channel conversation history), and replies. Built on raw Discord Gateway + REST over **stdlib only** — no discord.py needed.

## How the pieces fit



## 1 Install PRANA

🤖 AUTOMATIC

Open **PowerShell** and run:

PowerShell

```
$ git clone https://github.com/Thegreatprabh/Prana.git
$ cd Prana
$ python -m pip install -e .
# use `python -m pip` (not bare `pip`) — on some machines they point to different
Pythons
```

## 2 Save your AI key (BYOK)

🤖 AUTOMATIC

PowerShell

```
$ prana --save-key
Paste API key (hidden): ••••••••••••
API key saved for openai → C:\Users\YOU\.prana\config.json (0600)
```

Provider auto-detected from the key prefix. The key is never logged or echoed.

## 3 Create the Discord application

👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP

1. Go to **discord.com/developers/applications → New Application**
2. Name it (e.g. *PRANA*) → **Create**

That's the app shell. The bot identity comes next.

## 4 Copy the bot token

👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP

1. Open the **Bot** tab → click **Reset Token** → **Copy**

> ⛔ **TREAT IT LIKE A PASSWORD**
>
> Discord shows the token **exactly once**. Anyone with it controls your bot. Never paste it in a chat, screenshot, or public repo.

## 5 Enable the Message Content intent

👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP

Still on the **Bot** tab, scroll to **Privileged Gateway Intents** and turn **ON**:

✅ **MESSAGE CONTENT INTENT**

⛔ **THE #1 REASON BOTS LOOK DEAD**

Without this toggle, Discord delivers every message with **empty text** — PRANA connects fine but never "hears" anything. If your bot is online but silent, this is the cause 99% of the time. Toggle it, then **restart** `prana-discord`.

PRANA requests intents value `37377` = GUILDS · GUILD_MESSAGES · DIRECT_MESSAGES · MESSAGE_CONTENT.

## 6 Invite the bot to your server

👆 YOUR 2-MIN STEP

1. **OAuth2 → URL Generator** → check scope `bot`
2. Under **Bot Permissions** check: **Send Messages** + **Read Messages/View Channels**
3. Open the generated URL → pick your server → **Authorize**

You need *Manage Server* permission on the server to invite bots.

## 7 Give PRANA the token & start it

🤖 AUTOMATIC

**Recommended (persistent):** add to `%USERPROFILE%\.prana\config.json`:

%USERPROFILE%\.prana\config.json

```
{
  "discord": { "bot_token": "MTIz...paste-your-bot-token..." }
}
```

Alternative (this session only): `$env:DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN="..."` in PowerShell.

Then start the listener:

PowerShell

```
$ prana-discord
🤖 connected as @PRANA — listening on Discord
```

The startup handshake validates your token ( `/users/@me` ) before listening — a bad token fails fast with a clean error, no hanging.

## ✓ Verify it works

- ✅ Type `!help` in a channel → instant command list (zero tokens)
- ✅ Send a normal message → PRANA thinks and replies in the channel
- ✅ Give it a task: *"summarize what you can do"*
- ✅ History is per-channel — it remembers each thread

# Troubleshooting

| Error / symptom | Fix |
|---|---|
| `error: no Discord bot token — set DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN…` | Token not found. Check `discord.bot_token` in config.json or the `DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN` env var in the *same* terminal. |
| `error: Discord rejected the bot token` | Token is wrong or was regenerated. Bot tab → **Reset Token** → copy the new one. |
| `Bot is online but never replies` | **Message Content Intent is OFF.** Bot tab → enable it → restart `prana-discord`. (The #1 cause.) |
| `gateway: invalid session (bad token?)` | Token invalid — reset and replace it. |
| `gateway: timed out waiting for READY` | Network/firewall blocking Discord's gateway. Check connectivity; the listener retries with backoff automatically. |
| `Bot can't see a channel` | Re-check the invite URL permissions, and the channel's own permission overrides for the bot's role. |
| `Replies are split into pieces` | Normal — Discord caps messages at 2000 chars; PRANA chunks long replies losslessly. |

**ℹ️ BUILT-IN RESILIENCE**

Dropped gateway connections reconnect automatically with backoff (1s → 30s max). One bad message never kills the listener. PRANA never replies to its own messages.

# Quick reference

| Item | Value |
|---|---|
| Start listener | `prana-discord` |
| Env var | `DISCORD_BOT_TOKEN` |
| Config file | `%USERPROFILE%\.prana\config.json` → `"discord": {"bot_token": "..."}` |
| Intents | `37377` (Guilds · Guild Messages · DMs · Message Content) |
| Message limit | 2000 chars (auto-chunked, lossless) |
| Local command | `!help` (instant, zero tokens) |
| Proactive pings | Schedule jobs with `delivery_target="discord:<channel_id>"` |